One of my most enduring memories of Mumbai is of the Walking Tour of South Mumbai that Urmila and I took along with a few Reserve Bank colleagues on a pleasant Sunday morning. The young, knowledgeable and enthusiastic guide walked us along some of the historic precincts of Mumbai, telling us enchanting stories about those magnificent buildings and the rich and sometimes hidden tapestry of their cultural heritage. It was a wonderful lesson in history and a crash course on the evolution of architectural styles—neoclassical, neo-Gothic, Indo-Saracenic, and of course, art deco—which you can't miss along Mumbai's iconic Marine Drive.

And since this is also a 'tell all' book of sorts, I might as well add that on a few occasions, although not too often, Urmila and I would tell the staff that we were going for a walk, take a taxi from down the street and wander off to explore the colours and sounds, and experience the hustle and bustle of Mumbai, taking cover under the volume and crowds of this megapolis.

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All directors on the board of the Reserve Bank, including the governor, sign an official declaration of fidelity and secrecy as laid out in the Bank's general regulations. Earlier on, the declaration used to be taken in a register, but in time, an elegant tradition has evolved—of signing on a scroll. The governor and deputy governors sign when they assume office, while the part-time directors sign before their first board meeting.

This reappointment meant that I was going to sign the scroll for a third time. I signed it the first time when I was appointed to the Reserve Bank board in my capacity as finance secretary, and the second time at the beginning of my first term. Grace Koshie, the meticulous and diligent secretary to the board, took great pride in maintaining and honouring the traditions of the Reserve Bank. She suggested a small ceremony around my signing the scroll after the reappointment, but she acceded to my request to keep it low key and I signed it in the quiet of my office.